A COMPLETE SAMPLE DOCUMENT

Northstar Project Handbook

A practical plan for a community learning and repair hub



A welcoming place to learn, repair, and build together.

This handbook follows a fictional team from its first community interviews through a small public launch. It includes a project brief, operating procedures, a budget, a sample invoice, a delivery plan, and a review checklist.

EDITION 1.0 12 PAGES 5 BOOKMARKED SECTIONS

About this sample

All names, dates, amounts, and scenarios are fictional. The file contains selectable text, nested bookmarks, images, tables, internal links, external links, and editable form fields. No password is required.

FRONT MATTER

Contents & reading map

Read this handbook in order, or use the clickable contents and the PDF bookmark panel to jump directly to a chapter. The two front-matter pages are deliberately placed before the first top-level bookmark.

Section	What you will find	Pages
Chapter 1: Planning	Purpose, users, scope, and measurable requirements	3-4
Chapter 2: Operations	Daily workflow, ownership, and quality checks	5-6
Chapter 3: Finance	A consistent launch budget and a sample invoice	7-8
Chapter 4: Delivery	A 90-day roadmap and a structured review	9-10
Appendix: Reference	Glossary, acceptance checklist, and review form	11-12

How the document is organized

Five top-level bookmarks identify chapters and the appendix. Each contains two second-level entries, and the second entry contains one third-level detail bookmark. Some child entries share a page with their parent, which is normal in real reports.

- Chapter starts are on pages 3, 5, 7, 9, and 11.
- Page numbers in this document refer to physical PDF positions, starting with the cover as page 1.
- Cross-chapter links work in the complete document. A split section can retain only internal links whose destination remains inside that section.
- The form on page 12 can be filled in with a PDF viewer that supports interactive forms.

> **Navigation practice**
>
> Start with the project brief on page 3, then follow its link to the requirements page. For an external-link check, use the example reference website.

SECTION START

CHAPTER 1 / PLANNING

Start with a useful purpose

1.1 The project brief

Northstar is a proposed neighborhood space where residents can attend practical workshops, borrow basic tools, and get help with small repairs. The team will begin with two sessions each week, using a shared room rather than signing a long lease. A modest pilot makes it possible to learn before committing to larger running costs.

The first objective is clear: help 60 residents complete at least one practical activity during a 90-day pilot. Success means more than registrations. The team will record attendance, completed activities, equipment availability, and whether visitors feel confident trying the same task again at home.

Who the service is for

- First-time visitors who want patient guidance and simple instructions.
- Volunteer hosts who need clear opening, booking, and closing procedures.
- Partner organizations that can refer residents or provide workshop space.
- The small coordination team responsible for schedules, spending, and follow-up.

> **A decision rule**
>
> Choose an activity only when it can be explained simply, supervised safely, and completed with the tools available during the pilot. A smaller reliable offer is more useful than a broad list that the team cannot deliver.

The next page turns this purpose into concrete requirements. Continue to 1.2 Requirements on page 4.

CHAPTER 1 / PLANNING

Define the first release

1.2 Requirements

The first release needs a booking list, a visible workshop schedule, a short equipment register, and a simple way to record a completed visit. The team can use a spreadsheet for the pilot as long as every record has an owner and a review date. A new custom application is outside the initial scope.

Requirement	Acceptance condition	Owner
Booking	A resident receives a clear session date and capacity status.	Coordinator
Equipment	Every shared tool has a label, location, and condition entry.	Workshop host
Attendance	The host can record arrivals without collecting unnecessary data.	Session lead
Feedback	Visitors can answer three short questions after the activity.	Volunteer

1.2.1 Constraints and change control

A requirement is ready only when another person can check it without guessing. If a new request arrives, the coordinator records its purpose, effort, and effect on the current plan. Requests that add cost or new equipment wait for the weekly review instead of quietly expanding the pilot.

- Use plain language on signs and booking messages.
- Keep a paper fallback for sessions with unreliable connectivity.
- Do not promise specialist repairs that the team cannot supervise.
- Record assumptions that need confirmation during the first month.

Within-chapter return link: back to the project brief on page 3. Cross-chapter reference: see the funding assumptions on page 7.

SECTION START

CHAPTER 2 / OPERATIONS

Make the work repeatable

2.1 Session workflow

A good session feels simple to a visitor because the team has prepared the details in advance. The host checks the room, confirms the equipment list, and reads the booking notes before opening. Visitors receive a short introduction that explains what the session includes, how to ask for help, and where to find shared materials.

Prepare › Welcome › Practice › Review

Stage	Practical action	Record
Before opening	Check the room and inspect the equipment needed today.	Opening checklist
At arrival	Confirm the booking and explain the activity boundaries.	Attendance list
During practice	Demonstrate one task at a time and invite questions.	Host notes
Before departure	Return equipment and ask for brief feedback.	Completion record

Each stage has one named owner. Shared responsibility can work, but the team still needs to know who will act if a visitor is waiting or a tool is unavailable. The coordinator reviews recurring problems and changes the next session plan when needed.

> **A useful handover**
>
> At the end of a shift, leave three facts for the next host: what changed, what needs attention, and what is already ready. This is more useful than a long unstructured message.

Continue to the quality checks on page 6. External reference placeholder: example.com/operations.

CHAPTER 2 / OPERATIONS

Check the complete experience

2.2 Quality checks

Quality means that a visitor can complete the whole journey, from seeing a session notice to finding the correct room and returning equipment. The team should therefore review the complete sequence rather than checking only individual signs or forms. A clear booking message is not enough if the arrival instructions are missing.

- Read a booking message as a first-time visitor and identify the next action.
- Follow the arrival route and confirm that room signs are visible.
- Check the equipment register against the tools actually available.
- Complete one attendance entry and one feedback entry using sample data.
- Ask a different host to follow the closing checklist without extra explanation.

2.2.1 Document and link checks

When a document is shared, its links should lead to the intended place. A link within a section should remain useful after that section is exported. A reference to another chapter may need the complete handbook, so the section should still explain the subject clearly without depending on that jump.

> **Review the result**
>
> Check the exported PDF itself. Confirm that the text is readable, images are present, tables have complete rows, and page order follows the planned section. Keep a short list of observations so that another person can repeat the same review.

Within-chapter navigation: return to the session workflow on page 5. To try an external email link, use qa@example.com; opening it does not send a message.

SECTION START

CHAPTER 3 / FINANCE

Give the plan a budget

3.1 Funding and forecasts

The fictional launch budget is $9,000. The team separates one-time setup costs from ordinary running costs so that an inexpensive first month does not create a misleading impression of long-term affordability. Every purchase needs a short explanation connecting it to an agreed pilot activity.

Launch item	Budget	Purpose
Room preparation	$2,400	Make the shared space usable for the pilot.
Furniture and storage	$1,800	Provide tables, seating, and labeled storage.
Tools and materials	$1,600	Support the first four workshop topics.
Digital setup	$900	Booking, printing, and basic communication.
Host training	$1,100	Prepare the volunteer team.
Contingency	$1,200	Allow for agreed unexpected costs.
TOTAL	$9,000	Illustrative figures, not financial advice.



Illustrative monthly income and costs. Exact values are listed on page 8.

A review should compare actual spending with this plan and explain the differences. Continue to the forecast detail and sample invoice on page 8.

CHAPTER 3 / FINANCE

Keep the numbers traceable

This illustrative forecast uses four pilot months. Total income is $10,600, total operating cost is $9,400, and the resulting surplus is $1,200. These are fictional planning figures, not historical results or a promise of future performance.

Month	Income	Cost	Surplus
Month 1	$2,100	$2,000	$100
Month 2	$2,400	$2,200	$200
Month 3	$2,800	$2,500	$300
Month 4	$3,300	$2,700	$600
TOTAL	$10,600	$9,400	$1,200

3.2 Sample purchase record

Invoice Number: NS-2026-008 Sample date: 05 Nov 2026

Supplier: Northstar Demonstration Supplies. Customer: Northstar Pilot Team. This sample is included to provide realistic table and text content; it is not a request for payment.

3.2.1 Invoice line items

Description	Qty	Unit	Amount
Repair supplies	2	$75.00	$150.00
Workshop kits	10	$18.00	$180.00
Printed participant packs	20	$4.00	$80.00
TOTAL (no sample tax)			$410.00

Before a purchase is approved, the owner checks the quantity, the agreed price, and the activity that will use the items. Corrections should be recorded beside the original entry rather than replacing its history without explanation.

Within-chapter reference: return to the launch budget on page 7. Reference website: example.com/finance.

SECTION START

CHAPTER 4 / DELIVERY

Deliver in manageable stages

4.1 The 90-day roadmap

The roadmap creates time to learn before the public launch. A stage is complete when its expected result is visible, not simply when its calendar dates have passed. If an important dependency is late, the coordinator adjusts the next stage instead of asking the team to hide the delay.

Stage	Days	Visible result
Discovery	1-14	Residents and hosts agree on the first activities.
Setup	15-35	Room, equipment register, and booking process are ready.
Pilot sessions	36-60	The team completes small sessions and records observations.
Public launch	61-90	The schedule expands only after the pilot is reviewed.

Ownership and dependencies

Every milestone has an owner, a short acceptance statement, and a dependency list. For example, the first public workshop depends on a prepared host, working equipment, a usable room, and a booking message that people can understand. Missing any one of these items changes the experience.

- Review the next two weeks in detail rather than pretending every later date is fixed.
- Keep changes visible to the people affected by them.
- Close small issues promptly so that they do not become launch-day surprises.
- Choose a fallback activity if a planned tool or material is unavailable.

Continue to the weekly review on page 10. The acceptance checklist on page 12 provides a final cross-chapter reference.

CHAPTER 4 / DELIVERY

Turn observations into decisions

4.2 Weekly review

A useful review asks what happened, what it means, and what should change next. The team begins with observations from sessions rather than opinions about effort. Attendance, completed activities, equipment issues, and visitor comments help explain whether the current offer is working.

The coordinator shares a one-page summary before the meeting. Hosts add context when a number is easy to misread. For example, a lower attendance figure may reflect a cancelled session rather than weak interest. The meeting should lead to a small number of clear decisions, each with an owner.

4.2.1 Action log

Observation	Next action	Owner
Visitors ask where to return tools.	Add a labeled return point beside the exit.	Session lead
One workshop fills immediately.	Try a second small session before changing the full schedule.	Coordinator
Feedback forms are often unfinished.	Reduce the form to three clear questions.	Volunteer lead
A materials delivery is uncertain.	Prepare a fallback activity using current stock.	Workshop host

> **Keep the learning**
>
> At the end of the pilot, retain the decisions and the evidence behind them. The next team should be able to understand why the project chose its schedule, equipment, and workshop topics without reconstructing every conversation.

Within-chapter navigation: return to the roadmap on page 9. External reference: example.com/review.

SECTION START

APPENDIX / REFERENCE

A shared vocabulary

A. Glossary

Term	Meaning in this handbook
Acceptance condition	A visible result that lets another person confirm a requirement.
Assumption	Something the team believes but still needs to check.
Baseline	The agreed starting plan against which changes are compared.
Contingency	A reserved allowance for unexpected but agreed needs.
Dependency	A condition that must be satisfied before another activity can proceed.
Front matter	Introductory pages before the first main chapter.
Milestone	A specific result used to judge progress.
Pilot	A limited first version used to observe the real experience.

Reference notes

The same words should mean the same thing across a plan, a budget, and a review. If people use a term differently, add a short definition before the difference creates an avoidable misunderstanding. A glossary is useful only when its examples match the work being done.

This handbook uses a small fictional project so that every section can be read independently. The figures agree across the budget, forecast, and invoice tables. The page numbers and chapter titles are also used by the clickable contents and bookmark outline.

Continue to the acceptance checklist and form on page 12. Return to the contents on page 2.

APPENDIX / REFERENCE

Complete the final review

B. Acceptance checklist

Use this checklist when the pilot team is ready to share the handbook or one of its sections. Work from the actual PDF that another person will receive. A correct source document does not automatically prove that every exported file is complete.

- Confirm that the first and last expected pages are present.
- Read a paragraph and select a sentence to confirm the text remains selectable.
- Inspect the budget and invoice tables for missing or clipped cells.
- Check that illustrations and small transparent logos are visible.
- Open the bookmark panel and follow a retained internal bookmark.
- Try an internal link within the appendix and an external website link.
- Fill in the review fields below, save the PDF, and reopen it in your viewer.

B.1 Reviewer sign-off

These are real PDF form fields, not a screenshot of a form. They provide an additional check that standard form controls remain available when the appendix is exported as its own section.

Reviewer name

Reviewer email

☐ I completed the review checklist.

Within-appendix link: return to the glossary on page 11. External reference: example.com/checklist.